

RTI Sahayak

Right to Information Filing Assistant | Agentic AI Problem Statement

Problem Statement

An AI agent designed to assist citizens with filing Right to Information (RTI) applications, powered by RAG (Retrieval-Augmented Generation). It retrieves relevant RTI Act provisions, department jurisdiction data, and PIO contact directories from trusted sources. Citizens can describe their issue in plain language and receive a legally compliant, correctly addressed RTI application, along with automated tracking of the statutory response deadline and escalation support.

The Challenge

Citizens in India have a legal right to demand information from public authorities under the RTI Act, 2005, but most people don't use it because the process is confusing: identifying the correct Public Information Officer (PIO) and department, drafting a legally valid and non-vague application, tracking the mandatory 30-day response window, and knowing how to file a First Appeal if ignored. This gap disproportionately affects citizens with limited legal literacy — exactly the population the Act was meant to empower.

Our Solution

RTI Sahayak is a RAG-grounded AI agent that carries a citizen's request through the complete RTI lifecycle:

- Classifies the citizen's plain-language complaint to identify the correct department and PIO
- Drafts a legally compliant RTI application with specific, non-vague information requests (avoiding rejection under Section 7(9))
- Calculates and tracks the statutory 30-day (or 48-hour, for life/liberty matters) response deadline on a color-coded dashboard
- Auto-drafts a First Appeal under Section 19 of the RTI Act if the deadline lapses with no response

Every drafted clause is grounded in retrieved legal text rather than model-generated assumptions, ensuring zero-hallucination legal accuracy and building genuine citizen trust in the output.

Technology Used

- **IBM watsonx.ai (Granite model)** — Natural language understanding, legal drafting, and reasoning over RTI provisions
- **RAG (sentence-transformers + FAISS)** — Local vector retrieval grounding every drafted clause in actual RTI Act text
- **Python Flask** — Backend application logic and REST API
- **python-dateutil** — Statutory deadline calculation (30-day / 48-hour tracking logic)
- **IBM Cloud (Code Engine)** — Deployment and hosting infrastructure
- **Gunicorn** — Production-grade WSGI server
- **IBM BOB** — Development environment used to build the project end-to-end